FRESHROUTE COLLECTIVE - DECISION ARTEFACT

Feasibility, economics and controlled-pilot decision

Current decision case

£275/day
3PL route-cost scenario

£25/drop
current price test

~£56
monthly EBITDA at 21 SMEs

1.1%
EBITDA margin

£27.89
drop fee for 10% margin

£29.76
drop fee for 15% margin

Route-capacity boundary

Scenario	Supplier pickups	SME drops	Route time	Decision
Low density	3	8	4.70 h	Feasible; high cost/drop
Base	4	12	6.35 h	Feasible
Stretch	4	14	7.02 h	Planning ceiling
High density	5	16	8.00 h	No-go on time

Payload and receiving windows remain separate validation constraints.

Contracted 3PL cost envelope

3PL cost/day	Break-even SMEs	Fee for 10% margin	Decision
£225	18	£23.92	£25 price has headroom
£250	20	£25.90	Close to threshold
£275	21	£27.89	£25 case only around break-even
£300	23	£29.87	Break-even exceeds 21-SME ceiling

G0-G5 pilot gates

G0
3PL quote + registration/FBO + custody + insurance

G1
Qualified cluster + price test + real windows/weights

G2
Contracts + SOPs + temperature/custody controls

G3
Controlled pilot + real time/load/temp/OTIF/cost data

G4
Replace scenarios with actuals; viable price/cost envelope

G5
Scale only after stable service, compliance and ≥10% margin

Business-plan recommendation

Proceed to pre-pilot validation, not immediate full-scale launch. A live pilot is justified only after a qualified cluster, written compliance position, actual refrigerated 3PL quotation and a price/cost configuration with adequate operating headroom are demonstrated.